Amazon Clone – 3 Day Beginner Execution Plan

"You are not building Amazon.
You are proving you can build and ship a product in 3-4 days."

Phase 1 is your first real builder challenge. Pick this over the weekend as it requires full focus (continuous like a hackathon). Use AI for everything (use correct prompts)

In just 3-4 days, you will create and deploy a complete product using AI, just like real-world hiring assignments.

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Don't aim for perfection—focus on building, learning, and proving to yourself that you can ship something end-to-end. 🚀

GOAL

Build a basic Amazon-like e-commerce app with:
- Product listing
- Product detail page
- Cart
- Authentication
- Checkout (dummy)

STEP 0: TECH STACK

Frontend: React (Vite)
Backend: Node.js + Express
Database: MongoDB Atlas
Deployment: Vercel (FE), Render (BE)

Step 1: Understand What You're Building

Features Breakdown

1. Auth

- Signup
- Login
- Logout

2. Product

- Product list page
- Product detail page

3. Cart

- Add to cart
- Remove from cart
- Update quantity

4. Checkout

- Address form
- Order summary (no real payment)

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STEP 2: HOW TO USE AI (BEGINNER)

Understand 3 parts:
Frontend (UI), Backend (logic), Database (storage)

1. 🎨 Frontend (What user sees)

- Buttons, UI, pages
- Built using React / HTML / CSS

👉 Example: Amazon website UI

2. ⚙️ Backend (Brain of app)

- Handles logic
- Talks to database
- Handles login, cart, etc.

👉 Example: “Add to cart” logic

3. 🗄️ Database (Storage)

- Stores users, products, cart

👉 Example: Product list stored here

Flow:
User → Frontend → Backend → Database → Backend → Frontend

Use AI in small steps:
1. Setup React project
2. Create UI
3. Setup Node backend

4. Connect MongoDB
5. Create APIs
6. Connect frontend to backend

Rule for using AI

Don't say: "Build Amazon clone"
Say: "Build ONE small part"

Beginner AI Prompt Flow (STEP-BY-STEP)

🟢 Step 1: Setup Frontend
Explain how to create a React app using Vite from scratch. Assume I am a beginner and explain each command.

🟢 Step 2: Create UI
Create a simple product listing page in React with dummy data. Include basic styling.

🟢 Step 3: Setup Backend
Explain how to create a Node.js backend using Express from scratch for a beginner. Include how to run the server.

🟢 Step 4: Connect Database
Explain how to connect MongoDB Atlas to a Node.js Express app step by step for beginners.

🟢 Step 5: Create APIs
Explain what an API is and create a simple API to return a list of products in Express.

🟢 Step 6: Connect Frontend + Backend
Show how to fetch data from the backend API in React using axios and display it.

STEP 3: PROJECT STRUCTURE

Frontend:
src/
- components/
- pages/
- App.jsx

Backend:
server/
- routes/
- models/
- server.js

STEP 4: DATABASE

User: id, name, email, password
Product: id, title, price, image, description
Cart: id, userId, items: [{ productId, quantity }]

Concepts:
Schema = structure
Document = row
Collection = table

STEP 5: TIMELINE

Day 1:
- Setup FE + BE
- Auth + Product APIs

Day 2:
- UI pages
- API integration

Day 3:
- Cart
- Deploy

DELIVERABLES:
- Live link
- GitHub repo

RULE:
Build first. Understand later.

Common Mistakes (warn them)

❌ Trying to build EVERYTHING
❌ Watching tutorials instead of building
❌ Copy-pasting GPT code without understanding
❌ Not deploying

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What We Are Teaching You (Beyond Just a Project)

1. How to Build, Not Just Watch

- Most students watch tutorials and feel productive
- Here, you will actually build and ship a real product

This is the #1 skill companies care about

2. How Real Applications Work

You'll understand:

- How frontend talks to backend
- How backend talks to database
- How login, cart, APIs actually work

👉 This is real-world engineering, not theory

3. How to Use AI Properly

- Not copy-pasting blindly
- Breaking problems into small parts
- Asking the right questions

👉 This is a future-proof skill

4. How to Build Under Time Pressure

- You have only 3-4 days
- Just like real hiring assignments

You'll learn:

- Prioritization
- Speed + execution
- Decision making

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5. How to Debug & Solve Problems

- You will face errors
- You'll learn how to:
  - Google
  - Ask AI
  - Fix things yourself

👉 This is what separates beginners from developers

6. How to Deploy a Live Project

- Not just code — but make it accessible online

👉 You'll walk away with:

"Here's my live project" (huge confidence boost)

Important Note for Beginners

"This feels overwhelming"

Yes. It will.

Because:

- You're learning frontend + backend + database together
  You've never done this before

👉 That's normal. Everyone feels this.

What you should do instead

- Don't try to understand everything at once
- Focus on one step at a time
- Follow the plan blindly if needed

👉 Clarity comes after doing, not before

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1. You are not expected to know anything

2. Your goal is NOT perfection

- Your UI may look bad
- Your code may be messy

👉 Doesn't matter.

Done > Perfect

3. Everyone will struggle

Even the "smart" students:

- Will get errors
- Will get stuck

👉 The difference is: They keep going

4. This is your first real builder moment

After this project, you can say:

"I built and deployed a full-stack application"

That's a massive level-up

5. Confusion = Progress

If you feel:

- Lost
- Confused
- Frustrated

👉 Good. That means you're learning.

Golden Rule to Remember

"You don't learn development by understanding everything.
You learn by building despite not understanding."

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For the next 3 days:

- Ignore perfection
- Ignore fear
- Ignore comparison

Just focus on:

“Can I make this one feature work?”

Then next. Then next.

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